Larkspur Analytics

Employee Handbook 2026

Version 4.0 - Effective January 15, 2026 - Issued by People Operations

Welcome

Welcome to Larkspur Analytics. This handbook explains the policies, benefits and expectations that apply to all employees of Larkspur Analytics, Inc. ("Larkspur"). It replaces the 2025 edition in full and takes effect on January 15, 2026. Where a local law gives employees more generous terms, the local law applies.

Policies are owned by People Operations. If anything in this handbook is unclear, ask your manager or write to people@larkspur.example before acting on your own interpretation.

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1. About Larkspur

Larkspur Analytics builds data quality and demand forecasting software for mid-market retailers. The company was founded in 2019 and is headquartered in Denver, Colorado, with a second office in Toronto, Ontario.

1.1 Our values

- Customers first: we measure success by the decisions our customers make with our data.
- Write it down: decisions, designs and incidents are documented so others can learn.
- Own the outcome: we finish what we start and ask for help early.
- Be kind and direct: candid feedback, delivered with respect.

1.2 Employment classifications

Full-time employees are scheduled to work at least 30 hours per week. Part-time employees are scheduled to work fewer than 30 hours per week. Contractors are engaged through a written services agreement and are not employees of Larkspur. Unless a section says otherwise, the benefits in this handbook apply only to employees.

1.3 Introductory period

New employees complete a 90-day introductory period with a check-in at 30, 60 and 90 days. The introductory period does not change at-will employment.

1.4 Equal opportunity

Larkspur is an equal opportunity employer. Employment decisions are based on merit, qualifications and business needs, never on race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, age, disability, veteran status or any other protected characteristic.

2. Working Hours and Attendance

2.1 Core hours

Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 15:00 in the employee's local time zone. Outside core hours, employees organize their own schedules with their team. A standard full-time week is 40 hours.

2.2 Overtime

Non-exempt employees are paid overtime at 1.5 times their regular rate for hours worked over 40 in a week. Overtime must be approved in advance by a manager, except in an emergency.

2.3 Recording time

Time off, overtime and absences are recorded in Larkspur People, the HR portal. Managers approve time entries every two weeks before payroll closes.

2.4 Attendance

Tell your manager as early as possible if you cannot work as scheduled. Three or more unplanned absences in a rolling 60-day period are reviewed with your manager to see what support is needed.

2.5 Company holidays

Larkspur observes 11 paid company holidays each year. The holiday calendar for the following year is published every December. Employees who must work on a company holiday receive a floating day to use within 60 days.

3. Paid Time Off

3.1 Annual allowance

Full-time employees receive 18 days of paid time off (PTO) per calendar year. PTO accrues monthly at 1.5 days per month, starting on the first day of employment. Part-time employees accrue PTO in proportion to their scheduled hours.

3.2 Service increase

After three years of continuous service, employees receive 2 additional PTO days per year. The increase applies from the first full month after the employee's third work anniversary.

3.3 Carry-over

Employees may carry over up to 5 unused PTO days into the next calendar year. Carried-over days must be used by March 31. Any other unused days are forfeited on December 31 and are not paid out, except where local law requires a payout.

3.4 Requesting time off

Requests for three or more consecutive days should be submitted in Larkspur People at least two weeks in advance. Managers respond within 3 business days. Shorter requests can be made with reasonable notice.

3.5 Holidays and PTO

Company holidays do not count against PTO. If a company holiday falls during approved PTO, that day is not deducted from the employee's balance.

3.6 Volunteer day

Each employee may take 1 paid volunteer day per year for work with a registered charity. The volunteer day does not carry over.

4. Leave of Absence

4.1 Parental leave

Larkspur provides 16 weeks of paid parental leave to employees who become parents through birth, adoption or foster placement. Leave must be taken within 12 months of the child's arrival and may be split into up to two blocks. Employees become eligible after 90 days of employment.

Contractors, interns and temporary agency workers are not eligible for parental leave.

4.2 Medical leave

Employees with a serious health condition may take up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected medical leave in a rolling 12-month period. Short-term disability insurance replaces 60% of base pay during approved medical leave after a 7-day waiting period.

4.3 Bereavement leave

Employees may take up to 5 paid days after the death of an immediate family member and up to 2 paid days after the death of an extended family member.

4.4 Jury duty

Larkspur continues to pay full base salary for up to 10 days of jury service per year.

4.5 Returning from leave

Employees returning from parental or medical leave return to the same or an equivalent role. People Operations schedules a return-to-work conversation in the first week back.

5. Sick Leave and Wellness

5.1 Sick leave

Employees receive 8 paid sick days per year, separate from PTO. Sick days do not carry over. A doctor's note is required only for absences longer than 3 consecutive working days.

5.2 Wellness reimbursement

Larkspur reimburses up to $40 per month for gym memberships, fitness classes or wellness apps. Submit receipts in the expense tool by the 10th of the following month.

5.3 Employee assistance program

All employees and their household members can use ClearPath, a confidential counseling service, for up to 6 free sessions per issue per year.

5.4 Medical insurance

Larkspur pays 85% of medical insurance premiums for employees and 60% for enrolled dependents under the BlueRiver Health plan. Open enrollment runs each November, and coverage starts on the first day of the month after an employee's start date.

6. Remote and Hybrid Work

6.1 Eligibility

Most roles at Larkspur are hybrid. With manager approval, employees may work remotely up to 3 days per week. Fully remote arrangements require approval from the department's vice president.

6.2 Remote work stipend

Larkspur provides a remote work stipend of $500 per year to help employees cover internet, furniture and other home-office costs. The stipend is paid in the January payroll and is prorated for employees who join during the year.

6.3 Equipment

Larkspur provides a laptop, a monitor and a headset. Laptops are refreshed every 36 months. Equipment remains Larkspur property and must be returned within 10 days of an employee's last day.

6.4 Working from another country

Employees may work from another country for up to 30 days in any 12-month period with approval from People Operations, so that tax and immigration rules can be checked in advance.

6.5 Coworking allowance

Employees who live more than 50 miles from a Larkspur office may expense a coworking membership of up to $150 per month. The coworking allowance is separate from the remote work stipend.

7. Travel and Expenses

7.1 Booking travel

Book business travel through the company travel tool at least 14 days in advance where possible. Economy class is used for flights under 6 hours and premium economy for longer flights.

7.2 Per diem

Meals during business travel are covered by a daily per diem of $65 for domestic travel and $90 for international travel. The per diem is not paid for days when meals are provided.

7.3 Lodging

Hotel rates of up to $250 per night are approved automatically ($325 per night in New York, San Francisco and London). Higher rates need written approval from a director.

7.4 Receipts and deadlines

Itemized receipts are required for any expense above $25. Expense reports are due within 30 days of the expense; reports submitted more than 90 days after the expense are not reimbursed.

7.5 Corporate cards

Corporate cards are issued to employees who travel at least four times a year. Personal purchases on a corporate card are not allowed, even if they are repaid.

8. Learning and Development

8.1 Learning budget

Every employee has an annual learning budget of $1,500 for courses, books and certifications. Unused learning budget does not carry over to the next year.

8.2 Conferences

With manager approval, Larkspur covers registration and travel for up to 2 conferences per year. Employees who attend a conference share a short summary with their team.

8.3 Mentorship

The mentorship program pairs every new employee with a mentor outside their team for their first 6 months.

8.4 Tuition assistance

Larkspur reimburses up to $5,000 per year for degree programs related to the employee's role. Tuition assistance must be repaid if the employee leaves within 12 months of a reimbursement.

9. Code of Conduct

9.1 Conflicts of interest

Employees must disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest to People Operations within 30 days of becoming aware of it. Outside employment with a competitor, customer or vendor requires written approval.

9.2 Gifts and entertainment

Employees may accept gifts or entertainment worth up to $100 per year from any one vendor or customer. Cash and cash equivalents are never accepted.

9.3 Respectful workplace

Harassment, discrimination and retaliation are prohibited. Concerns can be raised with a manager, People Operations or the anonymous ethics hotline. Larkspur investigates every report promptly.

9.4 Use of company resources

Company equipment and accounts are provided for business use. Limited personal use is acceptable if it does not interfere with work or create security risk.

10. Information Security

10.1 Accounts and passwords

Use the company password manager for every work account. Multi-factor authentication is required for email, source code, cloud consoles and the HR portal.

10.2 Devices

Laptops must use full-disk encryption and lock the screen after 5 minutes of inactivity. Customer data must never be stored on personal devices or personal cloud accounts.

10.3 Reporting security incidents

Report a suspected security incident, lost device or phishing message to security@larkspur.example immediately, and in any case within 24 hours.

10.4 Training and access reviews

All employees complete security awareness training when they join and every year after that. Access to production systems is reviewed every quarter.

11. Acknowledgement and Contacts

11.1 Changes to this handbook

Larkspur may update this handbook. Changes are announced by email at least 30 days before they take effect, unless a change is required by law or only adds to employee benefits.

11.2 Contacts

- People Operations: people@larkspur.example
- Payroll: payroll@larkspur.example
- Security: security@larkspur.example
- Ethics hotline: available 24 hours a day

11.3 Revision history

- Version 4.0 (January 15, 2026): annual update; added the volunteer day.
- Version 3.2 (June 1, 2025): updated travel booking rules.
- Version 3.0 (January 10, 2025): first edition covering the Toronto office.

11.4 Acknowledgement

I confirm that I have received and read the Larkspur Analytics Employee Handbook 2026 and that I will follow the policies it describes.

Employee name: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____